

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

-----X
WILLIAM MCLEOD,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER DIA
ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT
MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-
Police Officers as yet unidentified,

Defendants.
-----X

Index #
Date of filing:

Plaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial

Basis of the venue is the
Locus of Occurrence

SUMMONS

Plaintiff resides at
114 Putnam Avenue, 1st Floor
Brooklyn, New York 11238

County of Kings

TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANT:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in the case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded herein.

Defendant's address:

THE CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street
New York, New York 10007

POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield #
28181
Tax ID # 966920
c/o New York City Police Department- Patrol
Borough Brooklyn South Community Response
Team
2820 Snyder Avenue
Brooklyn, New York 11226

Plaintiff's attorneys:

RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS.
26 Court Street, Suite 1200
Brooklyn, New York 11242
(718)522-1020

Defendant's address:

**POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-
Shield # 3739 Tax ID # 952318**

**c/o New York City Police Department- Patrol
Borough Brooklyn South Community Response
Team**

**2820 Snyder Avenue
Brooklyn, New York 11226**

**Dated: Brooklyn, New York
October 23, 2023**

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

-----X

Index No.:

WILLIAM MCLEOD,

Plaintiff,

COMPLAINT

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER DIA
ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT
MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-
Police Officers as yet unidentified,

Defendants.

-----X

Plaintiff, by his attorneys, RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS., complaining of the defendants herein, upon information and belief, respectfully shows to this Court, and alleges as follows:

**AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION FOR
FALSE ARREST ON BEHALF OF WILLIAM MCLEOD**

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the plaintiff was and still is a resident of the County of Kings, City and State of New York.
2. That all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, was and still is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing pursuant to the laws of the State of New York.
3. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, maintains a police force known as the NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT.
4. That prior hereto on December 23, 2022 and within the time prescribed by law, a sworn Notice of Claim stating, among other things, the time when and place where the injuries and damages were sustained, together with plaintiff's demands for adjustment or payment thereof, and that thereafter the CITY OF NEW YORK, refused or neglected for more than (30) days and up to the commencement of this action to make any adjustment or payment thereof, and that thereafter, and within the time provided by law, this action was commenced.

5. Pursuant to the General Municipal Law, the Statutory 50-H Hearing of the plaintiff was held on May 3, 2023.

6. That on November 18, 2022, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the defendant, POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, as police officers, agents, servants and/or employees.

7. That on November 18, 2022, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD was lawfully inside his vehicle at or about the intersection of Empire Boulevard and Utica Avenue, in the County of Kings, City and State of New York.

8. That on November 18, 2022, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD was approached, and was falsely arrested by defendants, POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, who were acting within the scope of their employment with the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, after exiting his vehicle at the aforesaid location.

9. That on November 18, 2022, the plaintiff was taken into police custody, and was transferred to the 71st Precinct where he was held for approximately three (3) hours until his release without being charged with a crime.

10. That on November 18, 2022, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the aforementioned false arrest was performed in a negligent reckless manner.

11. That on November 18, 2022, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief the defendants, POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, who falsely arrested the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, were acting within

the scope of their employment with the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK.

12. That on November 18, 2022, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the arrest and confinement was without probable cause nor based on reasonable grounds and not founded upon an arrest warrant.

13. That as a result of the aforesaid false arrest and confinement, plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD sustained serious permanent personal injuries along with humiliation, shame, indignity, damage to reputation and credit and suffered emotional and physical distress and injuries.

14. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION FOR NEGLIGENT
HIRING AND RETENTION ON BEHALF OF WILLIAM MCLEOD**

15. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "14" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

16. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, did not exercise reasonable care and diligence in the selection, engagement, employment and training of their agents, servants, and employees and were negligent in the hiring, training and retention of the defendants, POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, who violated the civil rights of the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD.

17. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, had prior knowledge of the inappropriate, unlawful, and improper conduct of the defendants, POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, and continued to employ them and allowed them to be in contact with the public at large.

18. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION FOR FALSE
IMPRISONMENT ON BEHALF OF WILLIAM MCLEOD**

19. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1 through "18" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

20. That on November 18, 2022, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the defendants, POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, were acting within the scope of their employment when they, without justification and without probable cause, imprisoned the plaintiff.

21. That the defendants POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, while acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally confined the plaintiff against his will and said confinement was not privileged.

22. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR
INTENTIONAL AND NEGLIGENT INFLECTION OF
EMOTIONAL DISTRESS ON BEHALF OF WILLIAM MCLEOD**

23. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "22" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

24. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, acted

intentionally, recklessly and with utter disregard to the consequences of their actions and caused severe emotional distress to the plaintiff through their actions.

25. Said actions exceeded all reasonable bounds of decency, were outrageous and shocking and resulted in severe emotional distress to the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD.

26. That as a result of said intentional and negligent acts, the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, become sick, sore, lame and disabled, received severe and serious injuries in and about diverse parts of his person and suffered great physical pain, distress, mental shock, mental anguish and psychological trauma and was otherwise injured.

27. By reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR MALICIOUS
PROSECUTION ON BEHALF OF WILLIAM MCLEOD**

28. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "27" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

29. That on November 18, 2022, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the defendants, POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, within the scope of their employment, without justification, without probable cause, created and submitted an erroneous police report in an effort to cover up the aforesaid and initiate a prosecution in bad faith. The officers failed to perform a proper investigation prior to the arrest and imprisonment of the plaintiff.

30. That on November 18, 2022, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the defendants, POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, were acting within the scope of their employment, maliciously prosecuted the

plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD.

31. That on November 18, 2022, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, as a result of the aforesaid malicious prosecution, plaintiff sustained serious, permanent, personal injuries along with humiliation, shame, indignity, damage to reputation and credit, legal fees, loss of employment opportunities and suffered emotional and physical distress and injury.

32. By reason of the foregoing, plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR CIVIL
RIGHTS VIOLATION ON BEHALF OF WILLIAM MCLEOD**

33. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "32" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

34. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, through policies, practices and customs, directly caused the constitutional violation suffered by the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD.

35. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, through its police department, has had and still has hiring practices that it knows will lead to the hiring of the police officers, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, lacking the intellectual capacity and moral fortitude to discharge their duties in accordance with the constitution and is indifferent to the consequences.

36. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, through its police department, has *de facto quota* policy that encourages unlawful stops, unlawful searches, false arrests, the fabrication of evidence and perjury.

37. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, at all relevant times, was, upon information and belief, aware that these individual defendants, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, routinely commit constitutional violations such as those at issue here and has failed to change its policies, practices and customs to stop this behavior.

38. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, at all relevant times, was aware that these individual defendants, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield #28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield #3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, are unfit officers who have previously committed the acts alleged herein and/or have a propensity for unconstitutional conduct.

39. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR
PUNITIVE DAMAGES ON BEHALF OF WILLIAM MCLEOD**

40. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "39" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

41. The actions of the defendants herein-above alleged, were malicious, willful and grossly negligent.

42. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, authorized, permitted and ratified the unlawful and negligent acts of their agents, servants and/or employees, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER DIA ABDALLAH-Shield # 28181, POLICE SERGEANT MICHAEL VENDITTI-Shield # 3739, and JOHN DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, herein-above alleged.

43. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

WHEREFORE, plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **First** Cause of Action; plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Second** Cause of Action; plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Third** Cause of Action; plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Fourth** Cause of Action; plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Fifth** Cause of Action; plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Sixth** Cause of Action; plaintiff, WILLIAM MCLEOD, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Seventh** Cause of Action; together with attorneys' fees, and the costs and disbursements of this action.

DATED: Brooklyn, New York
October 23, 2023

Yours, etc.,


ROBERT MIJUCA, ESQ.
RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS.
Attorneys for Plaintiff
WILLIAM MCLEOD
26 Court Street Suite 1200
Brooklyn, New York 11242
(718) 522-1020
File No.: 22WM11-18

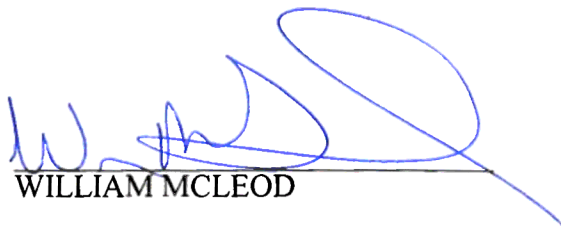
INDIVIDUAL VERIFICATION

STATE OF NEW YORK)

) SS:

COUNTY OF KINGS)

WILLIAM MCLEOD, being duly sworn, deposes and says, that deponent is the plaintiff in the within action; that deponent has read the foregoing **COMPLAINT** and knows the contents hereof; that the same is true to deponent's own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and that as to those matters deponent believes them to be true.


WILLIAM MCLEOD

Sworn to before me this 27th
day of October 2023


NOTARY PUBLIC

MAGDA MARIN-COLON
Notary Public, State of New York
No. 01MA6158891
Qualified in Richmond County
Commission Expires 1-16-2027